government, however, such an approach to foreign relations in southern Asia would actually prove counterproductive, by aggravating the local populations. Instead, the Indian government advocated making concessions to some of the nationalist and pan-Islamist movements, to demonstrate the empire did not stand in the way of progressive liberal reform in this region of the world. The following chapters will show who was right.

Russia

Together with knowing who was responsible for creating British foreign policy in the post-war period, and in understanding what influenced their thinking, another question to be answered is what role Russia played in these thought processes. The picture is unclear and often times confusing, as British officials contradicted themselves over how much of a threat they viewed Bolshevik Russia to be. Certainly the Bolshevik revolution ushered into Russia a political regime which was anathema to the majority of British officials. Thus, a large section of the literature on Anglo-Russian relations after 1917 focuses on the idea that Britain's policies towards its erstwhile imperial competitor were now conditioned by abhorrence of the Bolshevik ideology.

The problem with this argument, however, is that it oversimplifies a complex topic. Examples of British anti-Bolshevism are often extrapolated to explain the entirety of Britain's Russia policy in this period. For example, while it is more than likely that anti-Bolshevism influenced Britain's participation in the Allied intervention in the Russian civil war, this is not the whole story. As soon as one shifts focus from the north intervention to the south of Russia, one sees that the Malleson mission to Meshed and the Dunsterforce initiative in Baku, for example, were not conceived as part of an 'anti-Bolshevik crusade'.[80] Instead, Malleson and Dunsterville were First World War manifestations of a decades long British obsession with the security of India's borders.

This is not to say that anti-Bolshevism did not influence the thinking of officials in Whitehall. The anarchy and violence which the October